

Customer & MVP Blueprint

AI Placement Coach for Indian College Students | Based on Day 22 Startup Validation Report | 12 August 2026

Executive Summary

- An AI-powered placement coach for Indian engineering/CS undergrads (years 2–4) that replaces content-hunting with a personalized Assess → Diagnose → Plan → Practice → Review → Simulate → Measure workflow.
- The real wedge is **prioritization, personalization and accountability** — not more content. LeetCode, GeeksforGeeks, HackerRank and YouTube already saturate content supply.
- Preliminary validation score: **6.2/10**. Problem severity (8/10) and market potential (8/10) are strong; founder-market fit (7/10) is promising. Differentiation (5/10) and external validation (2/10) are the weak links.
- **Verdict: conditional GO.** Build a narrow assessment + roadmap MVP and prove activation, retention and willingness to pay with real students before building the full platform.

Ideal Customer Profile

Attribute	Definition
Age / Stage	18–24, primarily university years 2–4
Market	India — engineering & technology undergraduates (~4.0M TAM per AISHE 2021–22)
Goal	Land a software engineering internship or full-time placement
Current Behavior	Already using LeetCode, GeeksforGeeks, YouTube and generic AI tools; wants structure
Core Pain	Doesn't know what to prioritize or whether preparation is actually sufficient
Willingness to Pay	Conditional — will pay if personalization and outcomes are demonstrably clear
Reachable Via	Campus communities, coding-club networks, student creators, referrals

Buyer Persona

“The Placement-Focused Student” — studies DSA and tutorials regularly, has bounced between multiple free resources, but still feels uncertain whether effort is going toward the right topics. Anxious about falling behind peers as placement season approaches.

Core objection: “Why should I pay when YouTube, GeeksforGeeks, LeetCode and free AI tools already exist?”

Top 10 Customer Pain Points

Pain Point	Severity	Product Response
Don't know what to study next	High	AI-generated personalized roadmap
Too many scattered resources	High	Single curated daily plan
Inconsistent practice, no accountability	High	Goal tracking + streaks/reminders
Can't judge placement readiness	High	Placement Readiness Score
Weak areas remain hidden	Med/High	Upfront diagnostic assessment
Interview anxiety	High	Mock interview simulator (post-MVP)

Pain Point	Severity	Product Response
Project portfolio uncertainty	Medium	Role-aligned project recommendations
Generic AI answers don't persist or adapt	Medium	Persistent curriculum & progress memory
Low confidence entering assessments	Medium	Weekly progress feedback loop
Unclear which companies/roles to target	Medium	Role- and company-specific prep paths

Customer Journey

Stage	What Happens
Awareness	Discovers via campus community, student creator, or a search for “placement readiness” / “prep plan”
Consideration	Takes the free readiness assessment; mentally compares it to free GfG/LeetCode/YouTube routines
Purchase	Converts after seeing a personalized roadmap and an early win in the first 3–7 days; low-friction monthly or annual price
Retention	Weekly readiness re-assessment, daily task streaks and (later) mock interviews drive habitual return; a placement outcome drives referral

Key Customer Objections

- “Why pay when YouTube / GeeksforGeeks / LeetCode / free AI tools already exist?”
- Low student budgets and price sensitivity
- Skepticism about the accuracy or credibility of an AI-generated readiness score
- Reluctance to adopt “yet another platform” on top of existing habits

Key Buying Triggers

- Placement season or internship application window opening
- A failed or upcoming online coding assessment
- Feeling behind peers who are further along in preparation
- Wanting a defined 30/60/90-day preparation plan

MVP Recommendation

Build first: the free diagnostic assessment → AI-generated personalized roadmap → daily task list → basic progress tracking. This is the smallest slice that tests the core hypothesis (personalization + accountability beats content).

Do NOT build yet: mock interview simulator, project-recommendation engine, company-specific tracks, native mobile app, gamification/social features, or an original content library — curate/link to existing resources instead.

Success metrics: assessment completion rate, Day-7 activation/return rate, % of daily tasks completed (plan adherence), conversion rate in the monetization test, and qualitative signal from 20–50 test users.

MoSCoW Prioritization

Priority	Scope
Must Have	Diagnostic assessment, AI roadmap generator, daily task assignment, basic progress tracking
Should Have	Placement Readiness Score, weekly re-assessment, email/WhatsApp reminders
Could Have	Mock interview simulator, project recommendations, peer/percentile benchmarking
Won't Have (MVP)	Full content library, native mobile app, company-specific question banks, gamification/social feed, counseling marketplace

Pricing Hypothesis

Freemium entry: free diagnostic assessment + first roadmap. Paid tier unlocks daily tracking, readiness-score updates and (later) mock interviews.

Plan	Price (illustrative)	Status
Monthly	Rs. 199–Rs. 299 / month	To be tested Days 25–27
Annual	Rs. 999–Rs. 1,999 / year	To be tested Days 25–27

These are planning assumptions, not confirmed prices — validate directly with the target ICP before scaling.

Top 5 Risks

Risk	Likelihood / Impact	Mitigation
Crowded market (LeetCode, GfG, HackerRank, YouTube, generic AI)	High / High	Own the narrow readiness workflow; don't compete on content volume
Unproven willingness to pay	High / High	Run a real payment test by Day 27, before any further build
Weak retention	High / High	Anchor product around a daily workflow with visible progress
AI commoditization (ChatGPT etc. can replicate advice)	High / Med-High	Build proprietary progress history and workflow lock-in over time
Customer acquisition cost	Med-High / Med-High	Lean on campus communities, creators and referrals over paid ads

30-Day MVP Plan

Days	Focus	Output / Target
1–5	20–30 student interviews	Top recurring pain points, ranked
6–10	Landing page + free assessment live	50–100 signups
11–17	MVP build	Assessment + AI roadmap + daily tasks + tracking
18–24	User testing	20–50 real users; measure activation & retention
25–27	Monetization test	Rs. 199–Rs. 299/mo or Rs. 999–Rs. 1,999/yr
28–30	Decision	Double down / Pivot / Stop

Founder Action Sheet — Top 10 Next Actions

- Conduct 20–30 structured student interviews to validate and rank the top pain points
- Ship a simple landing page with the free readiness assessment as the lead magnet
- Build the diagnostic assessment (10–15 targeted questions across DSA, CS fundamentals, projects, interview readiness)
- Build v1 of the AI roadmap generator — prompt-based is enough to start, no custom ML needed
- Drive 50–100 signups via campus groups, coding communities and student creators
- Instrument activation and Day-7 retention tracking from day one
- Run structured testing with 20–50 real students; capture both quantitative and qualitative feedback
- Test a real price point (Rs. 199–Rs. 1,999 range) before Day 28 — don't wait for the product to feel “finished”
- Define explicit kill/pivot triggers up front: no return visits, incomplete diagnostics, plan not followed, zero payment
- Make the Day 28–30 call decisively: double down, pivot to the strongest alternative wedge, or stop

Scores (0–100)

Dimension	Score	Rationale
Customer Clarity	70	Clear ICP and persona, but zero direct customer interviews conducted yet
Problem Severity	80	Strong hypothesis, supported indirectly by GfG/LeetCode demand — not yet by direct research
PMF Potential	55	Large, credible market, but a crowded field and undifferentiated positioning so far
MVP Readiness	60	Narrow MVP scope is well defined; nothing has been built or tested yet

PROMISING BUT UNVALIDATED

A strong problem thesis and a large addressable market, but zero paying customers, no LOIs or waitlist, and unproven differentiation. The right next move is the narrow 30-day MVP test above — not a larger build — with explicit kill/pivot criteria if activation, retention or payment don't show up.